Mission Scheme, made general suggestions about autonomous areas, the powers of provincial Governments and the Centre, and about such issues as the princely states and the amending power. They also drafted a resolution, closely resembling the Objectives Resolution".[8d]

CRITICISM OF THE CONSTITUENT ASSEMBLY

The critics have criticised the Constituent Assembly on various grounds. These are as follows:

1. ***Not a Representative Body:*** The critics have argued that the Constituent Assembly was not a representative body as its members were not directly elected by the people of India on the basis of universal adult franchise.

2. ***Not a Sovereign Body:*** The critics maintained that the Constituent Assembly was not a sovereign body as it was created by the proposals of the British Government. Further, they said that the Assembly held its sessions with the permission of the British Government.

3. ***Time Consuming:*** According to the critics, the Constituent Assembly took an unduly long time to make the Constitution. They stated that the framers of the American Constitution took only four months to complete their work. In this context, Naziruddin Ahmed, a member of the Constituent Assembly, coined a new name for the Drafting Committee to show his contempt for it. He called it a "**Drifting Committee**".

The time taken by the framers of other constitutions is given in Table 2.7.

4. ***Dominated by Congress:*** The critics charged that the Constituent Assembly was dominated by the Congress party. In this context, Granville Austin, an American constitutional expert, remarked: "The Constituent Assembly was a one-party body in an essentially one-party country. The Assembly was the Congress and the Congress was India."[9]

5. ***Lawyer–Politician Domination:*** It is also maintained by the critics that the Constituent Assembly was dominated by lawyers and politicians. They pointed out that other sections of the society were not sufficiently represented. This, to them, is the main reason for the bulkiness and complicated language of the Constitution.

6. ***Dominated by Hindus:*** According to some critics, the Constituent Assembly was a Hindu dominated body. Lord Viscount Simon called it 'a body of Hindus'. Similarly, Winston Churchill commented that the Constituent Assembly represented 'only one major community in India'.

IMPORTANT FACTS

1. The elephant was adopted as the symbol (seal) of the Constituent Assembly.

2. Sir B.N. Rau was appointed as the constitutional advisor (Legal Advisor) to the Constituent Assembly.

3. H.V.R. Iyengar was the Secretary to the Constituent Assembly.

4. S.N. Mukherjee was the chief draftsman of the constitution in the Constituent Assembly.

5. Prem Behari Narain Raizada was the calligrapher of the Indian Constitution. The original constitution was handwritten by him in a flowing italic style.